

DESARAE MCNAIR

TECHNICAL PRODUCT
MANAGER

CONTACT

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WEBSITES:

LinkedIn:
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/alkendria-mcnaire/>
Portfolio: <https://desaraemcnaire.github.io/>

SKILLS

- Product:** Product Discovery • Product Strategy • Requirements Gathering • Roadmapping • MVP Planning • Agile • Stakeholder Management
- UX & Analysis:** User Research • HCI • Persona Development • User Journeys • Service Design • Process Improvement • Data-Driven Decision Making
- Technical:** Python • SQL • AWS • Azure • Machine Learning • Cybersecurity • Mainframe/COBOL • Technical Communication

LEADERSHIP, SERVICE, AND CERTIFICATIONS

IBM Z Student Ambassador | Technical outreach, events, and student engagement
Vice President & Founding Member, LSAMP | Student recruitment, STEM programming, and organizational

EDUCATION

December 2025

Master of Science (M.S.) in Computer Science

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

December 2023

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Cyber Security

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS, US

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Product Management professional with a background in Computer Science, cybersecurity, machine learning research, and higher education. Experienced in user research, requirements gathering, UX strategy, stakeholder collaboration, and translating complex technical needs into practical product solutions.

EXPERIENCE

September 2026 - Present

Adjunct Instructor

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Design and deliver undergraduate instruction in **Mainframe Systems and COBOL**, translating complex enterprise computing concepts into practical learning experiences.
- Develop technical course materials, assessments, and hands-on activities aligned with learning objectives.

July 2024 - Present

Academic Advisor

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Manage an advising portfolio of **572+ undergraduate students**, using student performance and engagement data to identify needs and develop individualized success strategies.
- Collaborate with faculty, administrators, and support services to resolve complex issues and improve student outcomes.
- Identify process and communication gaps and connect students with resources that support retention and degree completion.

January 2024 - December 2025

Research Assistant

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

development

U.S. Army, Motor Transport Operator |
2013–2016

**IBM Project Management Professional
Certificate** — In Progress, Expected Dec.
2026

- Developed machine learning models to analyze network traffic and identify **IoT cybersecurity anomalies**.
- Evaluated data patterns and refined algorithms to improve detection accuracy and model performance.
- Presented technical findings and translated research results into actionable recommendations.

January 2023 - December 2023

Equipment Specialist

University of Southern Mississippi, Hattiesburg, MS

- Managed technical equipment projects from initiation through completion while coordinating requests, deliverables, and multiple stakeholders.
- Provided technical troubleshooting and support for hardware and software systems.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

- **Neuro Adapt AI Product Strategy** | UX Design | AI/ML

Designed an adaptive learning platform concept that uses AI to personalize educational experiences based on individual learning patterns, preferences, and interactions.

- **Student Job Connect Product Strategy** | UX Design

Designed a student employment platform prototype connecting college students with flexible, degree-relevant work opportunities through user research, persona development, and MVP feature planning.

- **Advising Hub Technical Product Management** | UX Strategy

Developed a centralized advising platform prototype inspired by the needs of 572+ students, focused on academic planning, communication, and student success.